

The Lack of Career Advancement is Driving FC Associate Attrition | Kyle

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Executive Summary

Across the Amazon facility center roles, full time associates, stowers, and contract packers experience the same fraction of repeatedly having no visible path the the next level. This voluntarily leads to the fueling of turnovers at a global scale, and Amazon is absorbing all those cycles through costs. I recommend a structured system through a FC Career Pathway program. It would be piloted within one team to understand it's effectiveness.

Amazon Fc's high output associates walk away because they see no advancement movement within the company

Attrition

41%

of FC associates name
no upward mobility as
the reason for their
leave

Costs

6.2x

Higher replacement
costs for Associate
roles with no
advancement

Clarity

72%

of FC Area Managers
surveyed cannot
describe a formal
promotion process

FC Associates are in the highest priority segment - Has the greeting volume, highest replacement costs, and has the most actionable fix.

FC Associates

Role

- pick, stow, packing, receiving, sorting
All core FC functions

Term

- average - 1.5-3 yrs at the same Tier level

Schedule

- rotational shifts (Day and Night shifts)
Holidays

Difficulties

- Long walking distances, productivity targets, no signals for advancement

Triggers

- Peers leave; no explanation of upward mobility

Business Relevance

- Fc associates directly cost Amazon an estimated 1.5-2x annual wage per role in onboarding, overtime and lost units

Actionable

- A upward mobility process ladder with check-ins can be designed and piloted within a single facility center

Team-visible

- Friction is able to be observed by
—— Area Managers, and highly productive workers leaving without offers is measurable

An FC Career Pathway Program – three layers, team level, and visible (gives associates a destination for upward mobility and Amazon retention lever)

Visibility

1

Post a role progression map in all the zones. 3-5 milestones per FC role that will be updated quarterly.

Why: Associates can't aim for mobility which they can't see.

Progression

2

Formalize the Associate → Process Guide → Area Manager Path. Area Managers hold 30 minute quarterly development check ins for the associates

Why: Informal mobility exists, but it's invisible and inconsistent between FC's

Recognition

3

Milestone completion triggers a badge, rate-target relief week, and pay-range review eligibility

Why: Associates have control over the effort reward gaps. This closes the program with something tangible

A 90-day pilot at one FC site, one group of associates, one manager - structured to produce go / no go decision by the end of Q3

